

Massive housing up to saturation point



To rid the State of huts and slums once and for all and equip every needy village with all basic amenities, the Government

launched INDIRAMMA Integrated Development in Rural And Model Municipal Areas, during 2006-07. In all, 20 lakh houses will come up in 2007-08 and the target for 2008-09 is 30 lakh houses. Grant of pensions to widows, the aged and the handicapped forms part of INDIRAMMA.

Exclusive university for rural students

For the first time in India, Andhra Pradesh has launched a university with three IIIT campuses exclusively for meritorious rural students to enable them compete with their urban counterparts. Jawahar Knowledge Centers in districts

are providing IT job-oriented training to engineering and other graduates.

Food production hits all-time high

Andhra Pradesh is poised to record the highest ever foodgrains production of 200 lakh tons during the current year (2007-08). A farmer-oriented State Government has facilitated this by providing free power and loans at lesser interest to farmers and tenants and writing off their power bill arrears, bringing vast areas under new irrigation projects, and promoting alternate crop strategies. AP has been chosen as a model State for launching National Food Security Mission.



Hi-tech surgeries at no cost to the poor

BPL families breathe freely as they can undergo life-saving and costly surgeries in corporate hospitals without paying a rupee. The Government at its cost has provided insurance cover of up to Rs. 2 lakh each to BPL families under 'Rajiv Aarogyasri', a component of Rajiv Health Mission. Any one living anywhere in the

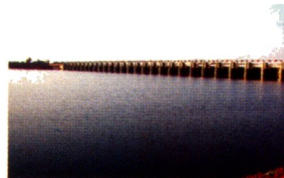


State can avail of free ambulance service or get medical guidance by dialing toll free numbers 108 and 104.

History in the making in irrigation sector

Unprecedented in the annals of Indian history is the Andhra Pradesh Government's program to bring One crore acres under irrigation at a cost of Rs. One lakh crore. Proving skeptics wrong, the Government had already created a new ayacut of 12 lakh acres by December 2007, and is all set to take it to 30.43 lakh acres by March 2009.

The budget for 2008-09 allocates Rs.16,500 crore for irrigation. This 'Jalayagnam', meant to save farmers from famines and floods, will harness river waters now flowing into the seas.



Hyderabad leaps to new heights

The inauguration of a state-of-the-art international airport near Hyderabad on March 14, 2008 marked the metamorphosis of Hyderabad into a world-class city. Construction of a 160-Km long eight-lane, Rs.4000-crore Outer Ring Road (ORR), 11.6 Km. Rs. 600-crore Elevated Expressway to the airport and Rs.8,400/-crore Hyderabad Metro Rail Project, all under way, will make Hyderabad city hassle free and investor friendly.



Women empowered with 3% interest (Paavala Vaddi) on loans

A unique Government scheme that is radically transforming the countryside is the extension of loans to rural women at 3% interest ('paavala vaddi' in Telugu). SHG women who take bank loans and promptly repay them are reimbursed the interest they pay over 3%. The loans have helped around 80 lakh women climb out of poverty. Banks will have given more than Rs.6500 crore this year by March 31, 2008. The target for 2008-09 is Rs.10,000 crore. AP accounts for 42 per cent of loans extended to SHGS all over India.

